

said in the *Cochrane Review* journal.

The researchers looked at key-hole, or laparoscopic, surgery in which an assistant operated a camera that acted as the surgeon's eyes during gall bladder removal. The review looked at different technologies, including Intuitive Surgical Inc's market-leading da Vinci system, and found no differences in deaths, the need to switch to more complicated surgery, total operating time, or length of stay in hospital.

To see how well robots performed the job in place of humans, Gurusamy and colleagues analysed data from five studies involving 453 people. The results showed no appreciable difference in the number of gall bladders that broke during surgery.

Robot suit for farmers

Japanese researchers have unveiled a robot suit that helps reduce the heavy burden of harvesting as the nation's farm industry faces an ageing, shrinking workforce.

Researchers at Tokyo University of Agriculture and Technology demonstrated the prototype of this wearable assistance machine equipped with eight motors and 16 sensors. The 25kg device can assist elderly farmers who need support for their leg muscles and joints when they keep a crouching position or lift their arms high.

The researchers are looking to commercialise the suit in two to three years.

"Human robotic technology is being applied to various industries but it has great potential in the agricultural industry in which people have to bear a heavy burden," said Professor Shigeki Toyama.

Toyama expected robotics would increasingly be put to use in farming in Japan and smaller European countries, where there is not enough space for large-scale agriculture and manual labour is costly.

Internet radio for your car

Australian technology is powering the world's first Internet car radio, which



World's first Internet car radio from miRoamer

will soon provide drivers worldwide with access to 30,000 stations from around the globe. With the simple push of a button, users can access AM/FM stations or Internet radio's thousands of music, entertainment, news and talk stations, all from the same car stereo.

The first model will connect to a 3G/HSDPA/HSPA device via Bluetooth for Internet connectivity.

With the radio connected to a smartphone on an unlimited data plan, you get in-dash navigation of tens of thousands of miRoamer stations, already available via computer and available for access by car.

Developed by Melbourne-based online radio aggregator miRoamer, the technology was unveiled in prototype form at the 2009 Consumer Electronics Show in Las Vegas.

Internet-connected TVs

Toshiba would soon come up with a new Internet-connected TV in which the owner of the TV will be able to access Yahoo! and Intel technology to view movies, listen to music, and check the news headlines, the week's weather forecast and even sports and other content from the Web.

Toshiba's Yahoo!-Intel products will also include support for Microsoft's Windows Media Center technology, which is a part of Windows

Vista Home Premium, Windows Vista Ultimate and the upcoming Windows 7. The Media Center software turns PCs equipped with TV tuners into a digital video recorder.

These Internet-connected TVs would be available in the US in the second half of this year.

Wireless LCD TVs

LG Electronics has developed LCD TVs with wireless capability, where external components connect to a separate module that sends the signals over-the-air to the TV.



LG LH85 series wireless LCD TV

The LH85 series, which consists of the 119cm 47LH85 and the 140cm 55LH85, promises uncompressed delivery of 1080p content without wires, thanks to the use of a proprietary 60GHz radio and multi-element antenna array.

Other than the wireless capability, the TVs feature a 120Hz refresh rate (not the 240Hz rate seen on many other LG models) with dejudder processing and extensive picture controls,